

Cirqlback — Business Guide (Basic / Core Plan)

Business — Basic (Core plan) · User Manual

For: single-location local businesses running loyalty with Cirqlback on the **Core (\$19.99/mo)** plan — or the free **Starter** 6-month trial. **Log in at:** </auth>

Which plan am I on? *Starter* = free 6-month trial (great to get going). *Core* ("Basic") = \$19.99/mo — everything you need to run loyalty at one location. Need more locations, unlimited taps, or priority support? See the [Pro Guide](#).

1. Getting started

1. Go to </auth> and choose **Create an account** → sign up as a **Business**.
2. Verify you can sign in, then open your **Merchant Dashboard** at </merchant>.
3. Fill in your business details (name, address, description, category). Your address puts you on the **Discovery Map** so customers can find you.

Your plan at a glance (Core):

	CORE
Business locations	1
Campaigns	Unlimited
Customer taps / month	500
Cirql tags included	20
Analytics	Tap & redemption analytics
Support	Email
Add-ons	Available to purchase

2. Core concepts

- **Cirql tag** — an NFC sticker/stand at your counter. Customers tap it to earn.
- **Campaign** — the rule behind the reward (e.g. "Buy 5, get 1 free" punch card, or a % discount).
- **Reward** — what the customer earns; each has a code they redeem in-store.
- **Tap** — one customer interaction. Your plan includes a monthly tap allowance.

3. Create your first campaign

From the Merchant Dashboard:

1. Open **Campaigns** → **New campaign**.
2. Pick a **type**:
 - **Punch card / loyalty** — set a **tap goal** (e.g. 5). The reward unlocks every Nth tap.
 - **Discount** — a percentage or fixed value.
3. Give it a **name** and **reward** (e.g. "Free coffee"), set a value if relevant, and save.

4. Your campaign is now **live** and ready to attach to a tag.

Only the business that owns a campaign can edit or delete it — your campaigns are private to you.

4. Set up your Cirql tags

1. Open **NFC Tags** → **New tag**.
2. Give the tag a **location label** (e.g. "Front counter," "Patio") so you can track where taps happen.
3. Link it to a **campaign**.
4. You'll get a **tag URL** and a **QR code** — write the URL to a physical NFC tag (from the dashboard's tag writer where supported) and/or print the QR as a backup.
5. Place the tag where customers can reach it. Test it with your own phone.

You can **rename, re-point, or deactivate** your own tags anytime. Each tag tracks its own tap count.

5. Run the loyalty loop

Once tags are live:

- Customers **tap** → **earn** automatically. You don't have to do anything per-tap.
- When a customer completes a punch card or earns a discount, they show you a **reward code**.
- **Redeem it**: open the reward (staff can look it up by code) and mark it redeemed. A redeemed code can't be reused.

Group campaigns (optional): you can **join open multi-store campaigns** so your shop is part of a "tap at 3 shops" trail — a great way to share foot traffic with neighbors. Find joinable campaigns in the Merchant Dashboard's group-campaigns panel.

6. Analytics

Open **Analytics** (</analytics>) for real numbers from your taps and redemptions:

- **Total taps, active customers, rewards issued vs redeemed** (conversion rate)
- **Revenue** (from your entered sales data, or estimated from reward value)
- **Busiest hours** and your **peak window**
- **Top campaigns** and **top tag locations**
- A **recent-activity** feed (latest taps and redemptions)

Want deeper insights (best tag zones, return-visit timing, heatmaps)? That's the **Advanced Analytics** add-on (see §8).

Sales data: enter daily sales in the dashboard to unlock accurate revenue, average-order, and Cirql-driven-sales metrics.

7. Customer relationships

- **Favorites & reminders**: customers can favorite your shop. From the dashboard's **Reminders** panel you can send them nudges ("Your card's almost full!").
- **Your tap screen**: by default it shows your business name and offer. Want your **colors, logo, slogan, and links** on it? That's the **Custom Branding** add-on (§8).

8. Add-ons (optional upgrades)

Add-ons are per-business monthly upgrades you can buy from the **Add-ons** panel in your dashboard. Available on any paid plan:

ADD-ON	PRICE/MO	WHAT IT DOES
Custom Tap-Screen Branding	\$7.99	Your colors, logo, slogan & links on the customer tap page.
Advanced Analytics Pack	\$12.99	Best-performing tag zones, return-visit timing, busiest-hour heatmaps, redemption funnel.
Map Priority Placement	\$14.99	A boosted, highlighted pin on the discovery map.
Contest & Scavenger-Hunt Builder	\$14.99	Build multi-stop scavenger hunts and prize contests.

Buying an add-on takes you through secure checkout; it activates automatically once payment succeeds.

9. Billing & your account

- Manage your plan and see your current tier under **Account** (</account>).
- **Upgrade** to Pro or add add-ons via **Checkout** (</checkout>) — payments are processed securely by Stripe; Cirqlback never sees your card number, and the price is set server-side (you're always charged the correct plan price).
- On the **Starter** trial you may be offered a discounted rate to convert to a paid plan before the trial ends.

10. Tips & FAQ

How do I get more taps or locations? Upgrade to **Pro** (3 locations, unlimited taps, 50 tags, priority support).

A customer says their reward won't work. Check the reward code's status — it may already be **redeemed** or **expired**.

Can customers cheat the punch card? No — there's a per-tag cool-down, optional GPS proximity, and device fingerprinting to prevent rapid repeat taps.

Do customers need an account? No. They're anonymous unless they share an email to save progress.

Where do I place tags? Anywhere customers naturally pause — the register, the table, the exit. Label each one so your analytics show which spots perform best.

Need the bigger toolkit? See the [Pro Guide](#).